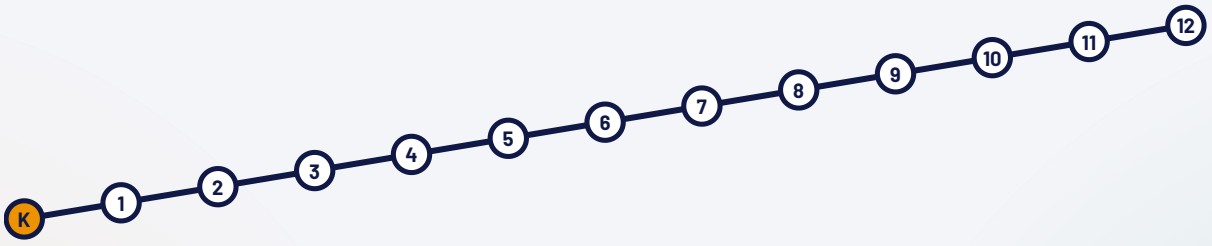
Awsaj Academy

K-12 VERTICAL ALIGNMENT · AN ANALYTICAL WALKTHROUGH

# Our Curriculum Journey: Grades 6–8

What our teachers' ratings tell us about how our standards are taught, K-12, and where we could go next.




**From the ratings you entered as teachers** (2,709 ratings, November 2026): what was reported as taught, not what students know.

# Contents


| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Middle school, Grades 6-8**<br>Grades 6 to 8, all four subjects. | 3 |
| 2 | **About the data (at the back)**<br>Where the data comes from, how to read the ratings, the words we use, the limits. | 10 |


Each part: the picture (curricular capacity, grade by grade), then Facts, Patterns and Moving forward, five items each. Items link to the Vertical Alignment site. About the data is at the back. 12 pages, A4.

Taught in depth  Introduced / exposed  Not taught

MIDDLE SCHOOL, GRADES 6 TO 8

# Middle school, Grades 6-8

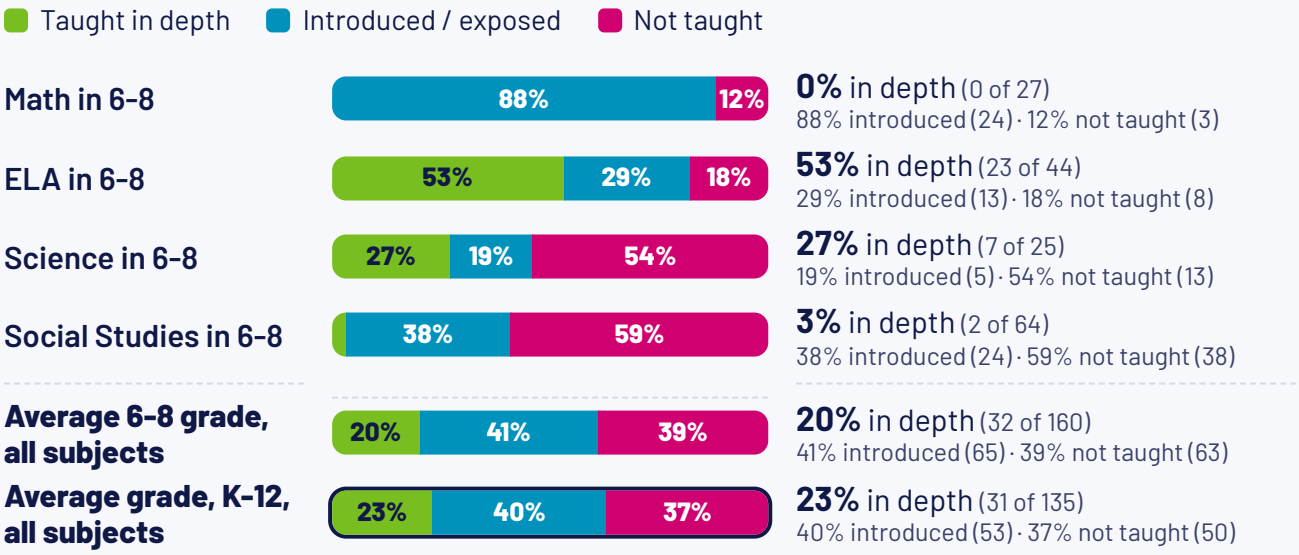
In Grades 6-8, teachers reported that 61% of the 479 grade-level ratings (336 standards; each grade rates the same 64 Social Studies standards) are at least introduced, and 20% are taught in depth. ELA is the clear strength at 53%, with Grade 7 ELA at 70%.

THE PICTURE

## At a glance: our curricular capacity

**What you are seeing.** An average grade in a year, by subject: green in depth, blue introduced, pink not taught, with the number of standards.

**What it adds to our story.** ELA is the strength of middle school. Math covers almost everything and rated none of its standards in depth.




Curricular capacity: what an average grade reports taking to depth, introducing or not teaching in a year. From 479 grade-level ratings, Essential Elements apart. Not a target.

Open the coverage map on the site ↗

THE PICTURE

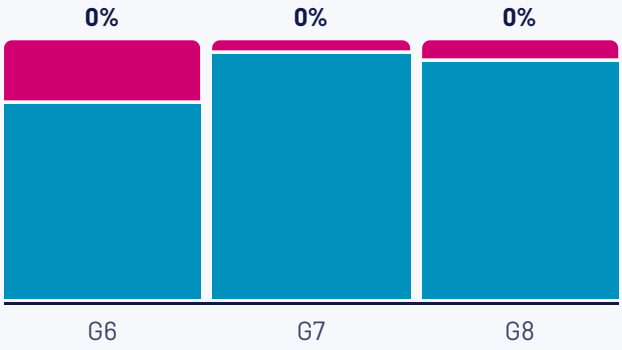
# Grade by grade

**What you are seeing.** One column per grade. The top number is the share taught in depth.

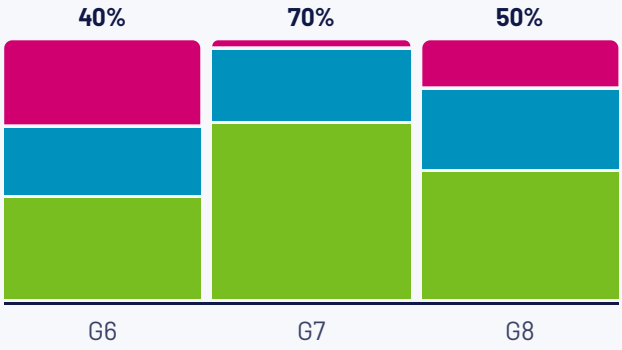
**What it adds to our story.** Each middle school grade has its own mix, and Science seems to give each grade its own discipline.

Taught in depth | Introduced / exposed | Not taught

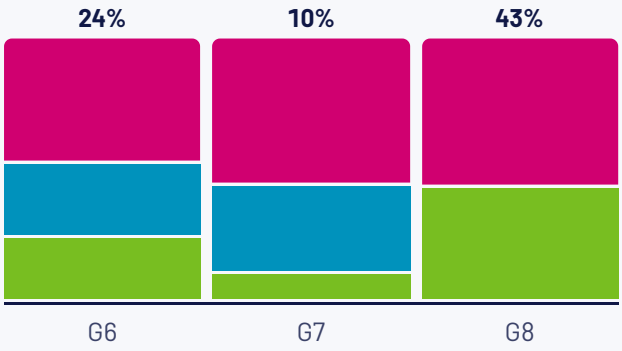
## Math



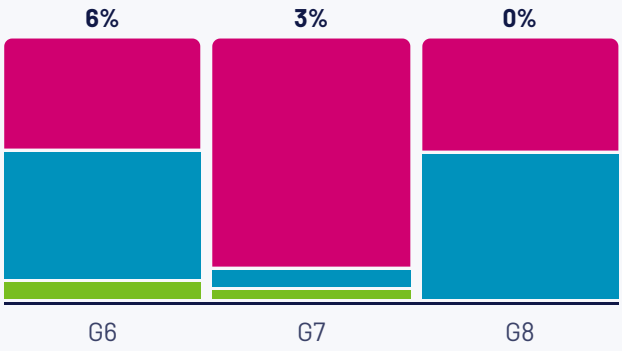

## ELA




## Science




## Social Studies



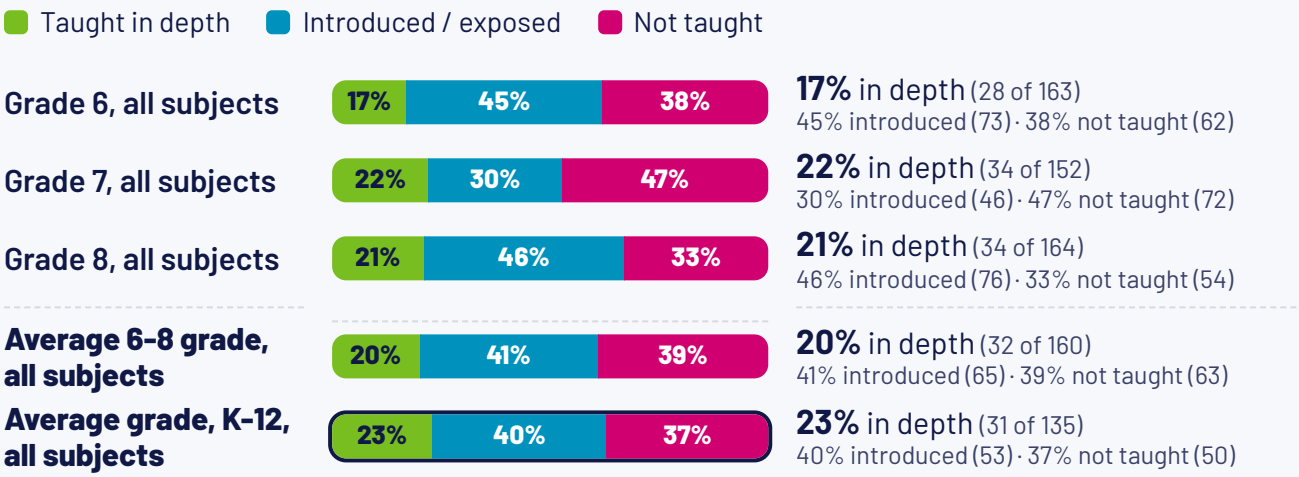

Open the grade dashboards ↗ Gaps and repetition ↗ Progressions ↗

THE PICTURE

## Our curricular capacity

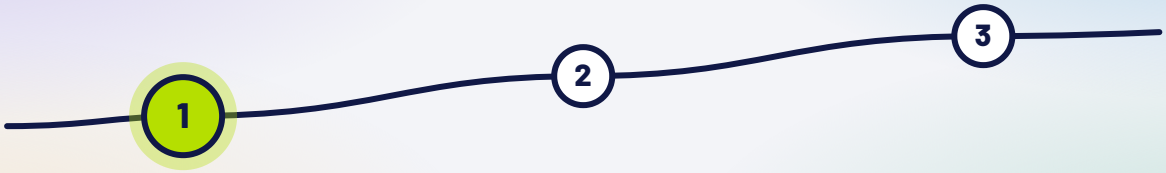
**What you are seeing.** One bar per average grade in a year, with the number of standards beside it; the school average last.

**What it adds to our story.** A 6-8 grade takes 20% of its grade-level standards to depth in a year (about 32 of 160), introduces 41% (65) and does not teach 39% (63). The average grade K-12, all subjects, takes 23% to depth (about 31 of 135).



6-8 · OUR CURRICULUM JOURNEY

**Section 1: Facts**




**Facts**
YOU ARE HERE

Patterns

Moving forward

SECTION 1 OF 3

# Facts

**What you are seeing.** The five main facts. Each links to its data on the site.

**What it adds to our story.** Two very different pictures sit side by side: a good place to compare how teams read the scale.

1. BRIGHT SPOTS **ELA is strong in every strand.** Writing is 59% in depth, Speaking and Listening 58%, Reading 52% and Language 45%. Grade 7 Reading stands out at 89% in depth. Grade 7 dashboard ↗

2. GAPS **52 standards are not taught in their own grade.** ELA 24, Social Studies 18 and Math 10. In Social Studies, Inquiry Practices, History and Political Science have no standard in depth in any grade (0 of 99 ratings). Gaps and repetition ↗

3. GAPS **Progressions: 12 break down, all in ELA.** 12 of the 48 ELA, Math and Science progressions here break down on an official link, and 15 are taught at every step. 3 Social Studies progressions are not taught in any of Grades 6, 7 and 8. Progressions ↗

4. BREADTH WITHOUT DEPTH **159 standards are introduced but never in depth.** Math 71, Social Studies 40, ELA 38 and Science 10. In Math, Ratios and Proportional Relationships and Functions have no standard rated not taught. Gaps and repetition ↗

5. ANOMALIES **Two ratings with almost no middle ground.** Grade 8 Science rated 43% in depth, 57% not taught and nothing introduced. Grade 7 Social Studies rated 91% of the 64 standards not taught, against 44% in Grades 6 and 8. Coverage map ↗

6-8 · OUR CURRICULUM JOURNEY

**Section 2: Patterns**




Facts

**Patterns**
YOU ARE HERE

Moving forward

SECTION 2 OF 3

# Patterns

**What you are seeing.** What the facts show side by side. Possibilities to discuss, not conclusions.

**What it adds to our story.** Many differences here may come from how courses are scheduled and how strictly "in depth" was read, not from how much is taught.

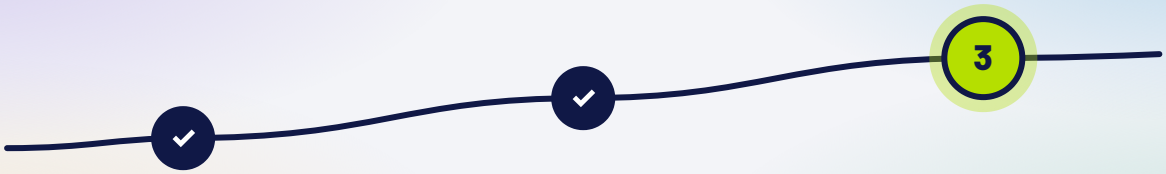
1. TRENDS ACROSS THE GRADES **Math falls into middle school and rises out of it.** Math in depth is 32% in Grade 5, 0% in Grades 6 to 8 and 30% in Grade 9. Three Grade 9 Math standards taught in depth build, on official links, on Grade 6 and Grade 8 standards rated not taught. Coverage map ↗

2. HANDOFFS **Grade 6 is where most progression findings land.** Grade 6 has 29 findings, the most of any grade K-12, many of them Grade 6 standards that build on K-5 standards rated not taught. Across 6-8, 26 standards taught in depth build on such K-5 standards, on suggested links. Progressions ↗

3. HOW WE RATED **Middle school Math rated almost everything "introduced".** Each Math team rated all its standards, and none in depth. A pattern this uniform may reflect a strict reading of "ALL classes, all or nothing"; the teams can tell us. Coverage map ↗

4. CHOICES AND CAPACITY **Science looks organised by discipline.** Grade 6 carries Earth and Space (67% in depth), Grade 8 Physical Science (62%) and Grade 7 mainly Life Science (15%). 29 standards are not taught in the grade or course where they fit, mostly because that grade teaches another discipline. Gaps and repetition ↗

5. CHOICES AND CAPACITY **Priority standards are deepest where teaching is already deep.** ELA priority standards are 68% in depth, above ELA as a whole (53%). Math priorities are rated like everything else (0%), and in Grade 7 Science 2 of 14 priorities are in depth and 6 not taught. Priority and power (Audit) ↗




SECTION 3 OF 3

# Moving forward

**What you are seeing.** Five questions for teams, each with its data and a first step we could take.

**What it adds to our story.** What students bring into middle school and carry on.

1 IMPROVING THE CURRICULUM **If Math introduces almost every standard, which 10 would we choose to take to depth first?**

*(Data: 71 Math standards introduced and never in depth; 10 not taught)* see Fact 2

**First step:** We could choose 10 middle school Math standards to take to depth next year, starting with ratios and expressions.

Gaps and repetition ↗

2 IMPROVING THE CURRICULUM **When a grade teaches mainly one Science discipline, how are the standards from the other disciplines taught?**

*(Data: 29 Science standards not taught where they fit; Life Science 7% in depth and 67% not taught (K-5 47%, Grade 11 50%))* see Pattern 4

**First step:** We could ask each Science grade to plan how it will teach the standards that fall outside its main discipline.

Gaps and repetition ↗

3 WORKING ACROSS GRADE LEVELS **Could the Grade 5, middle school and Grade 9 Math teams rate 5 standards together and compare?**

*(Data: Math in depth: Grade 5 32%, Grades 6 to 8 0%, Grade 9 30%)* see Pattern 1

**First step:** We might bring the Grade 5, middle school and Grade 9 Math teams together to rate 5 shared standards.

Coverage map ↗

4

KNOWING THE BANDS ABOVE AND BELOW **Which K-5 standards does Grade 6 most rely on, and has Grade 6 told Grade 5?**

*(Data: 26 standards in depth in 6-8 build on K-5 standards rated not taught (suggested links))* see Pattern 2

**First step:** We could ask Grade 6 teams to tell Grade 5 which K-5 standards they rely on most, checking each suggested link first.

Progressions ↗

5

HOW WE RATE AND PLAN **How is Social Studies scheduled across Grades 6 to 8, and where could its inquiry be taught alongside ELA?**

*(Data: Grade 7 rates 91% of the 64 standards not taught (Grades 6 and 8: 44%); 0 of 30 Inquiry ratings in depth)* see Fact 5

**First step:** We might plan one Social Studies inquiry unit with ELA in each middle school grade, using ELA's strength in research and argument.

Grade 7 dashboard ↗

WHERE THE NUMBERS COME FROM AND HOW TO READ THEM

# About the data

What our teachers reported about how our standards are taught, K-12. Eight parts: the whole school, the three grade bands and the four subjects. Each part opens with the picture (curricular capacity, grade by grade), then Facts, Patterns and Moving forward, five items each.

ABOUT THE DATA

## How to read this paper

> **What you are seeing.** How the ratings were made, what the three ratings mean, and the words we use.
>
> **What it adds to our story.** It helps us read every number fairly: these are teachers' reports of teaching, not measures of what students know.

What our teachers reported about how our standards are taught, K-12. Eight parts: the whole school, the three grade bands and the four subjects. Each part opens with the picture (curricular capacity, grade by grade), then Facts, Patterns and Moving forward, five items each.

**Where the numbers come from.** The ratings sheet of 9 November 2026 (2,166 standards, 2,709 ratings), checked against the Vertical Alignment reports.

**The three ratings.**

| Rating | What it means |
|---|---|
| Taught in depth | ALL classes in the grade consistently teach, reteach, review and assess the standard |
| Introduced / exposed | Anything in between (for example, 3 of 5 classes) |
| Not taught | No class in the grade teaches it |

**Keep in mind.**

- The ratings report teaching across a whole grade, not what students know, and they judge no one.
- "In depth" is all or nothing. Teams may have read it more or less strictly.
- Much literacy is also taught in Science and Social Studies, and may not show in the ELA ratings.
- Shares are of grade-level ratings. Essential Elements are counted apart.

**Curricular capacity.** What an average grade reports taking to depth, introducing or not teaching in a year. Not a target: we cannot teach everything equally, so we choose the mix on purpose.

**Categories.** Each item carries a small label (for example Bright spots, Gaps, Handoffs), the same set in every part, so a team can follow one kind of observation across parts.

ABOUT THE DATA

## Method, sources and limits

> **What you are seeing.** How the ratings were made, what the three ratings mean, and the words we use.
>
> **What it adds to our story.** It helps us read every number fairly: these are teachers' reports of teaching, not measures of what students know.

Every figure in this paper was computed from the ratings sheet and cross-checked against the site. Where the site's band and K-12 views differ (progressions), the paper says which it uses. Percentages are rounded half up, as on the site.

### What was read

| Source | How it was used | How fully it was read |
|---|---|---|
| Ratings sheet, "All Standards and Ratings K-12" (9 Nov 2026) | Every figure | All 2,166 rows |
| Organized ratings workbook | Cross-check of totals | All tabs |
| 20 Findings decks (band and subject) | Cross-check, questions and next-step themes | All slides and speaker notes |
| K-12 Reports PDF (118 pages) | Cross-check | First 80 pages scanned by search; a few read directly |
| 7 other Reports PDFs | Cross-check of headline figures | Scanned by search, not read page by page |

### How terms are used

- **Rated standards.** One rating is one standard in one grade. A standard shared by several grades is counted once for each grade that rated it.
- **At least introduced.** Rated in depth or introduced.
- **Not taught where it belongs (confirmed).** The grade the standard belongs to rated it not taught (for a standard shared across grades, every grade that shares it did). In Math and ELA each standard belongs to one grade, so this means that grade's team rated it not taught; it does not mean other grades should have taught it.

- **Not taught where it fits.** Each standard was placed in the grade or course where it fits best, and that grade or course rated it not taught. Other grades were not asked to rate it.
- **Introduced, never in depth (met but not owned).** Introduced in at least one grade and in depth in none.
- **Progression finding.** An automatic check on a chain of linked standards: a step not taught, or a standard in depth while the one it builds on is not taught.
- **Taught at every step.** Every standard in the chain, across two or more grades, is at least introduced.
- **Progression.** A chain of linked standards across grades. Official links are the Coherence Map (Math), anchor standards (ELA) and the standards' own structure (Science, Social Studies). Other links are suggestions.
- **Curricular capacity.** The average number of standards one grade rated in depth, introduced and not taught in a year (all ratings divided by the number of grades), rounded.
- **Hand-over gap.** A standard taught in depth while a standard it builds on, placed in an earlier school, is rated not taught.
- **Priority and power standards.** Standards the school's own documents name: power standards in K-5, priority standards in 6-12.

**Limits to keep in view**

- Ratings are teachers' judgements of teaching across a grade. They are not observations and not student results.
- Grades may have read "in depth" differently. Uniform ratings across a whole grade are a reason to check how the scale was read; the paper points these out so teams can discuss them.
- Each team rated its own subject. Literacy taught in Science and Social Studies, and Math taught in Science, may not show in the ELA and Math ratings.
- Middle school Science and high school Math, Science and Social Studies standards were placed in the grade or course where each fits best. 24 K-5 Social Studies standards are also rated not taught in the grade where they fit.
- Band counts of progressions look only at steps inside the band, so they do not add up to the K-12 figure.
- Literacy audit figures come from the 2026 PK-5 literacy audit of weekly plans.
- Some strands have few standards in a grade, so a single rating can move a percentage a long way. Counts are given where this matters.
- Suggested links between standards (most ELA, Science and Social Studies hand-overs) have not been checked by teachers.

**Status.** This is a draft for the Vertical Alignment Committee. Each finding should be checked with the teams concerned before it is treated as settled. The planned review of weekly and unit plans (Part 2) will test many of these patterns against what is actually planned.